



Profile

Personal Information

Name Kinyua, Tony *Munene*
Preferred Name Munene
Sex, Birthdate Male, 09/19/2001

Contact Details

Email, Phone tony.munene00@gmail.com, +254.706105912, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent Address 8th Floor Equity 75104-00200 Upperhill, Nairobi, NAIROBI, 00200, KEN

Demographics

Military Status None
Hispanic or Latino/a/x No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Other, Meru Speak, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 18 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested Yes, Signed: TONY MUNENE KINYUA
I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents Married
Home Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name Mr. Jeremy K Imwati
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone imwatijk@gmail.com, +254.722748369, Mobile
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Engineer, Employed, Assistant Manager, Kenya Revenue Authority
Education Graduated from college/university
Bachelors (1994), **Moi University, Uasin Gishu, KEN**

Parent 2

Mother

Name Mrs. Charity K Kinyua
Birthplace Kenya
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Other, Unemployed
Education Some high/secondary school

Siblings

1. Brian M Kinyua, Age 14, Brother, Some high/secondary school
2. Michael G Kinyua, Age 8, Brother, Some grade/primary school

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Kapsabet Boys High School, P.O Box 10, C 36, Kapsabet, Kapsabet, Nandi, KEN, Public
(02/2016 - 11/2019)

Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2019

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 13 / 379, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)
Enlish - (REG)	Enlish - (REG)	Enlish - (REG)
Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)
Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)
Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)
Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)
Geography - (REG)	Geography - (REG)	Geography - (REG)
Business Studies - (REG)	Business Studies - (REG)	Business Studies - (REG)

Honors

3rd Runner-up Brookside Mathlete Competition (AIC Chebisaas)	National	12
Position 1 Kapsabet Boys Longhorn Geography Contest	State/Regional	11
Position 1 Kapsabet Girls' Kiswahili contest	State/Regional	9

Subject Champion(Best in a Subject)- Physics, Business Studies, Biology	School	11, 12
Principal's Award - Chemistry	School	11, 12

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Equity Leadership Program
Counselor	Beverly Kufwafwa
Email, Phone	beverly.kufwafwa@equitybank.co.ke, +254.763105050

Future Plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	710	10/03/2020
Math	740	10/03/2020
Essay	16	10/03/2020
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
English	A-	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A-	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Biology	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Geography	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE
Business Studies	A	11/2019, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Athletics: JV/Varsity

9, 10, 11, 12, PG School 14 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr Continue	Rugby, Captain of rugby team (Labbies) 2017/2018, Kapsabet Boys High School Riftvalley region semi-finalists 2018. Grew the club's membership by 20 students. Organized a training session with the national 7s rugby team
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Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12, PG Break 5 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr Continue	Youth Organizing Secretary, Methodist Church of Kenya, Komarock Circuit Supervised cleaning of church compound; arranging and decorating grounds during special events. Successfully raised Ksh.100,000 for a youth excursion.
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Work (Paid)

PG School 8 hr/wk, 8 wk/yr Continue	Relationships Officer, Equity Bank Kenya, Donholm Branch Transacted over Ksh. 100,000 daily. Linked over 50 bank accounts daily to their respective owners' mobile phones; Opened over 100 bank accounts
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Family Responsibilities

9, 10, 11, 12, PG Break 25 hr/wk, 12 wk/yr Continue	Eldest sibling Cooking whenever my mum arrives late; helping my siblings with their homework; doing laundry and general house cleaning
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Student Govt./Politics

10, 11 School 14 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr Continue	Sports Captain 2017/2018, Kapsabet Boys High School Managed the school's sports equipment. Coordinated over 1000 students during the games period. Cultivated the school's sporting culture
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Community Service (Volunteer)

12, PG	Team Captain, Kenya Methodist Church - Komarock soccer team
Break	
4 hr/wk, 14 wk/yr	Successfully ran a Ksh. 50,000 fundraiser campaign for the team. The team keeps the youth engaged during school holidays: to keep them away from crime
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

9, 10, 11, 12	Chairperson, Kenya Revenue Authority Club - entrepreneurship club
School	
3 hr/wk, 36 wk/yr	Developed students' entrepreneurial ideas. Introduced the club in 3 surrounding schools. Presented skits on financial literacy at school events
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11	Class Secretary, Kapsabet Boys High School
School	
5 hr/wk, 2 wk/yr	Coordinated our class during a clean up exercise in the surrounding Kapsabet town. Set up litter bins; educated the residents on sanitation.
Continue	

Environmental

9	Chipukizi Scout, Kenya Scouts Association
Break	
5 hr/wk, 2 wk/yr	Planted 100 trees at Newlight Senior Girls' School, Kitengela and cleaned up the school compound,; intensive leadership training
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

Music filled the air without effort, like waves filling holes in beach sand; the sound rushed around every room in the house. As I sang along to 'Book of Rules' by The Heptones, memories flooded my mind.

"*Kanjo! Kanjo!*" someone shouted.

Before I could react to this, Kinoti, one of our employees, had flung the door close as fast as he could. I was eight at the time, but I knew what was happening. The Nairobi City Council officers, better known as '*Kanjo*', were a force to reckon with. Running an unlicensed shop, an encounter with them would leave you Ksh. 10,000 poorer, and with a nasty jail experience to narrate. Although they conducted impromptu raids, we would always be a step ahead of them due to the power of word of mouth. This was the first rule of operating my mother's shop – always be in the know. By the time the *Kanjo* arrived, we had long closed.

Rule number two: Always double-check the balances before handing them out; even triple check if you have to. You see, when I started helping out in my mother's kiosk, I first learned how to operate the cash register. I would take over and serve a customer or two at times, as my mother kept a watchful eye in case I gave extra balances. The cash register would occasionally break down in the middle of my tally, leaving me to improvise with my mother's phone. However, one thing remained constant – the balance I gave was always correct. One time my mother made a phone call to a customer, days later, to claim Ksh. 100 that I had given in extra balance. For sure, she got it back. She was dead serious about rule number two!

Rule number three: always address the customer by his name unless he /she was new, and we rarely got new customers. Ours was a community kiosk. It was always *Mama Brian* for ½ a kg of sugar or our neighbor requesting a loaf of bread on credit. Outside my tight community of my best friend (Caleb) and my two younger brothers, I hardly talked much to anyone. There I was, at ten years, starting at the cash register, yet I didn't know anyone's name. I was only familiar with the faces. By now, you probably think that after some time at the cash register, I mastered all our customers' names by heart. Well, I never did. I tried, but I was terrible with names. How my mother managed to remember still amazes me. However, making new customers feel warmly welcomed was something that I learned as a substitute for my poor memory. My cheerful smile lit everyone's heart when they came to shop. Over time, my mother learned to appreciate that I made customers feel 'at home'. It was customer service 101.

My mother calls out from the verandah; her voice, as clear as thunder, jolts me back to reality.

My experience at my mother's shop has shaped my life to date: from mastering the art of interpersonal skills, to learning basic economics. I learned how to maintain conversations with older people at a tender age.

Kids were accustomed to shoplifting sweets in shops like ours, and whenever my mother was not around, I had to make sure that it did not happen on my watch. I learned how to read body language to tell if the kids were lying. They mostly were.

Of all the things I picked up at my mother's shop, reggae music took the cake. I loved the reggae radio channel as much as I loved my Sunday ice cream treats. Reggae portals into my soul as if it were the keys to my safe; perhaps that is why I love it so much.

I quickly turn down the radio, with UB40 playing, and head over to the verandah.

Mama - mother

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

In December, right after high school, I began my fitness journey: going to the gym and morning runs to keep fit.

In February, I interned at Equity Bank, Donholm branch. I served at the Equitel desk, where I would help over 50 customers daily, link their bank accounts to their mobile phones for mobile transfers. I would also market other bank products like SIM cards. Our fieldwork projects raised awareness among the surrounding community on mobile money's importance in preference to physical cash. Daily interactions with customers helped me develop my marketing and customer service skills while introducing me to the corporate world.

My internship lasted for two months before the COVID-19 pandemic hit, and the bank suspended the program.

In May, I set out to learn how to program in Python. I used tons of free online material, from YouTube tutorials to full programming courses on edX. I built my first calculator, which performed basic arithmetic after a week. I was ecstatic. Soon enough, I was able to program a simple Mad Libs game, which I shared with my friends.

After the relaxation of the quarantine restrictions, my best friend and I collaborated to create a soccer team for our township youth. Donholm F.C keeps kids out of drugs and crime while nurturing their talents. With 20 members currently and overwhelming community support, we are a fast-growing soccer family.

In my free time, I take care of my younger siblings and do house chores to help my parents.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Yale University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2021
Admission plan	Restrictive Early Action
Financial aid	Yes
Arts Supplement	No
Prior to starting secondary school, have you lived for a year or more in another city?	No
Criminal History	No

Academics

As of this moment, what academic areas seem to fit your interests or goals most comfortably? Please indicate up to three.

Other Academic Interests? Computer Science & Economics

Other Academic Interests? Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

Why do these areas appeal to you?

My interest in cybersecurity developed after online fraudsters defrauded my father of Ksh. 10,000. However, what took me aback was my father's reluctance to report the incident to the relevant authorities.

From phishing to identity theft, Kenya faces its share of cybersecurity cases each year. It is quite disheartening for me to hear of cybercrime cases that have gone unreported because the victims do not know the cybersecurity laws in Kenya. Computer science appeals to my innate nature to empower others by raising awareness of cyber resilience. By educating people on how to navigate the web safely, and on the laws governing it, they can protect themselves. I hope to collaborate with the National Kenya Computer Incident Response Team to secure the Kenyan cyberspace

Yale is providing applicants the option to have their applications reviewed with or without ACT or SAT scores. Do you wish to have ACT or SAT scores considered with your application? Selecting no will not negatively affect your chances of being admitted.

Yes

Contacts

Previously Applied No

Contact 1 Contact with a current student or graduate, Jesse Njuguna Kimotho

Contact 2 Information session with multiple colleges near me

Contact 3 Yale website

Family

Sibling applied No

Relatives attended member No

Relative employed at member No

Additional Questions

Why Yale

Music, rugby, and Computer Science: I have always hoped to combine all these aspects of me. I cannot think of a better moment that encapsulates them than traversing the Yale campus, from David Malan's CS50 lecture recordings to the Upper Athletic Fields as the Yale Memorial Carillon plays the Simpsons theme song.

Yale offers the flexibility to embrace my diversity. At Yale, I can go from "Hello Tony. Welcome to CS50 Office Hours!" to "Yale ranger, life of danger!" and finally singing along to 'Stiff Necked Fools' by the Wailers at the International Festival of Art and Ideas in New Haven.

At Yale, I would not forgo my love for music or rugby for my Computer Science future.

1.What inspires you? Reggae music. Bob Marley for meditative Sunday afternoons, Don Carlos for monotonous house chores, and Culture for long drives to upcountry. You can never go wrong with reggae music's good vibes.

Yale's residential colleges regularly host conversations with guests representing a wide range of experiences and accomplishments. What person, past or present, would you invite to speak? What question would you ask?

Thomas Joseph Odhiambo Mboya – one of Kenya's founding fathers. Question: "Could you devise a winning strategy for Kenyans in the war against the ravaging scourge of corruption?"

3. You are teaching a Yale course. What is it called?

The fundamentals of dark memes: appreciating dark humor. Should I laugh? Or quickly scroll past it. I ponder as I click the 'follow' button on the r/darkhumor subreddit.

4. Most first-year Yale students live in suites of four to six people. What do you hope to add to your suitemates' experience? What do you hope they will add to yours?

Banter over Monday morning leg day workout. Late-night backend development for a bot that would manage our Fantasy Premier League teams. Binge on 'The Laundromat' on Netflix as I cook ugali.

Essays

Me: Visits Jumia (an online store in Africa) casually looking for earphones.

Me again: Opens Instagram only to see an earphone advertisement post on my timeline.

Why is it that I get bombarded by loads of protein supplements ads only after I look them up on Google?

Psychographic segmentation – a marketing strategy that leverages a customer's data and, with a foundation in psychology, uses data to create customer segments based on psychological characteristics.

I remember my mother urgently calling me to the kitchen to ask me whether she should accept cookies from a particular website.

"Free cookies! I hope they also make free deliveries," she said excitedly.

It took me a minute before I could convince her that those were not the regular artery-clogging cookies (probably not what Lou Montulli had in mind when he invented them in 1994). Instead, they were HTTP cookies – small pieces of data stored in a user's computer from specific websites - which help track one's online activities.

Data is now the world's most valuable commodity. With enough data points on a person, an algorithm can group one's personality, thus predict one's behavior. This fact fascinates me and scares me at the same time. Will the

next song I listen to, on my shower playlist, be 'Nenda lote' by Sauti Sol or 'Redemption song' by Bob Marley? An algorithm can figure this out.

P.S I'd probably play Bob Marley's song first.

The future is no longer unknown. It is predictable.

Chosen essay

Wisps of silver-grey smoke danced their way through the thick, hazy air as if excited to escape the gentle pull of gravity. William, my eldest cousin, rhythmically blew at the red sparks that had begun to emerge. Junior brought a Milo tin, Kings 'borrowed' some tomatoes and onions, and I scraped up leftover margarine from used containers. Curled up in the middle of my *cucu's shamba*, we assembled the ingredients for our 'lunch'.

My cousins and I did nearly everything together. Dressed in matching 50 Cent tracksuits, we would attend the local church together. William was our translator since he was fluent in *Kimeru* (or so we thought). After listening through the sermon without understanding anything, he would summarize the church service before journeying back. However, we realized that William would leave out critical parts of the sermon.

We decided to learn *Kimeru*. My *cucu's* late-night *MauMau* freedom fighting stories, which she narrated in *Kimeru*, pressured us to learn the language.

Learning *Kimeru* is a journey in which I am still on to date. So far, the most important lesson I have learned is the unifying ability of language. I feel a sense of belonging when putting together a grammatically wrong sentence in *Kimeru* as I talk to *cucu* over the phone.

"*Nkoikwa uichiumia* (I can hear that you're trying)," she would say.

"*Eee* (yes)," I smile as I fidget my pen between my index finger and thumb.

Cucu – Grandmother

Shamba - farm

Kimeru - my tribal language

Are you in the process of applying for an ROTC Scholarship? No

Yale-NUS: An Opportunity in Asia

Yale-NUS Application Yes

B.A./M.M. An Option Available to Exceptional Musicians

B.A./M.M. Program Interest No

Interviews

While an interview is not required for admission, depending on available resources it is possible that you might be offered an interview. In accordance with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), if you enroll at Yale you will have the right to read the interview summary. By checking the appropriate box, please indicate whether or not you wish to waive your right under FERPA to view this document. Waiving your right to read the summary is not a condition for receiving an interview, for admission to Yale, or for the receipt of any service or benefit from Yale.

I waive my right to review an interview summary.

I understand that my response may not be changed after I submit my application.

I understand

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.